# PRODUCT VISION BOARD

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## VISION

What is the reason for creating the product?
What positive change should it create?

Volunteers can organise their service around their lives and keep serving, so the corps has enough people when an emergency needs them.

## TARGET GROUP

Which market or market segment does the product address? Who are the target customers and users?

**Market**: Portuguese fire brigade associations, starting with a pilot station funded by the municipality. Later, other humanitarian organizations that rely on volunteers shifts.

**Customer**: Fire brigade association.

**Users**:

- **Volunteers and cadets:** support the crews with limited and irregular availability.
- **Supervisors**: build and publish the weekly schedule around members' unavailability, and are informed of every swap and cover;
- **Shift Operators**: dispatch crews and need to know who is on shift;
- **Station Chief:** needs an overview of who is available to find cover, organise training and respond to emergencies;
- **Professional firefighters:** have fixed shifts that are often extended due to emergencies;

## NEEDS

What problem does the product solve or which benefit does it offer? If you identify several needs, prioritise them and move the most important one to the top.

1) **Report availability and schedule shifts around it.** Volunteers and cadets report when they can't come, so they stop getting shifts that clash with work, studies or other commitments.
2) **Check and manage one's own schedule** without going to the station. Everyone can see the up-to-date schedule, and volunteers and cadets can negotiate swaps among themselves.
3) **Have enough people in emergencies and high fire risk.** When someone can't come, only free and qualified colleagues are asked to cover.
4) **Build the weekly schedule quickly and without conflicts**. Supervisors see members' unavailability and the required functions while they build it.
5) **An easy-to-use tool** that can be integrated into the daily operations without training.

## PRODUCT

What product is it? What are its three to five stand-out features that set it apart from competing offering? Is it feasible to develop the product?

**Type**: A mobile web app (PWA) for volunteers, cadets and professional firefighters, also usable on the station computers.

**Stand-out Features:**

- **Unavailability in own words:** AI reads the dates and the member confirms them; a form is always available;
- **Self-service shift swaps** between members, with a function check;
- **Centralised up-to-date live schedule** with notifications;
- **Presence confirmation and cover requests**, sent only to free and qualified colleagues;

**Feasibility**: Standard web technology with no integration needed with the current dispatch app in use. Built incrementally in Sprints.

## BUSINESS GOALS

How will the product benefit the company that develops and provides it? What are the desired business benefits? Prioritise them and move the most important one to the top.

1) **Reduce turnover among volunteers and cadets at the pilot stations,** so the corps can meet the minimum crew required in emergencies;
2) **Replace the printed Excel schedule and WhatsApp** with one live schedule
3) **Recurring revenue from selling the application to other fire brigades and humanitarian organizations** that rely on volunteers.
4) Additional revenue from **maintenance contracts** and **paid custom features**.



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# PRODUCT VISION BOARD CHECKLIST

Use the following criteria to effectively apply the Product Vision Board.

## VISION

- ☑ **Inspiring:** Describes the positive change the product should create.
- ☑ **Shared:** Unites people and creates alignment.
- ☑ **Ethical:** Gives rise to a product that does not cause any harm to people and the planet.
- ☑ **Concise:** Easy to understand and remember.
- ☑ **Ambitious:** Describes a big, audacious goal that might never be fully reached.
- ☑ **Enduring:** Provides guidance for the next five to ten years.

## TARGET GROUP

- ☑ **Clear:** The target group is clearly characterised, for example, by using demographics and behavioural attributes.
- ☑ **Specific:** You can tell if somebody is included in the target group or not.
- ☑ **Cohesive:** The members of a target group share similar attributes, e.g., age, lifestyle, disposable income. If that's not the case, then break up the target group and form several subgroups.

## NEEDS

- ☑ **Outcome-based:** Capture the reason why people would want to use the product. Describe what success looks like from the perspectives of the users and customers.
- ☑ **Specific:** The needs are detailed enough so that you can validate them.
- ☑ **Focused:** Concentrate on the main problem/benefit, the main reason for people to use the product.
- ☑ **Prioritised:** If you do identify several needs, prioritise them according to their importance for the target group.

## PRODUCT

- ☑ **Type:** It's clear what kind of product you want to offer, for example, mobile app on Android and iOS

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## OVERALL CRITERIA

- ☑ **Needs-first:** Start with the needs after you've captured the vision especially when you create a new strategy—be it for a brand-new product or for an existing one.
- ☑ **Validated:** The statements in the Target Group, Needs, Product, and Business Goal sections does not contain any major hypotheses and risks. They have been successfully validated, for instance, by interviewing and observing target users, building throwaway prototypes, and carrying out competitive analysis.
- ☑ **Adaptive:** The Product Vision Board is regularly reviewed and adjusted, at least once every three months as a rule of thumb.
- ☑ **Shared:** The key stakeholders and development team members have a shared understanding of the contents.
- ☑ **Connected:** The strategy captured on the board is systematically connected to more specific outcomes, preferably to an outcome-based, goal-oriented product roadmap like my GO Product Roadmap.

**To learn more about the Product Vision Board, read my book Strategize and attend my training courses. Please visit www.romanpichler.com for more information.**

